

Bridges and tunnels



Types of bridges



Brenner Bridge

Beam bridges are supported by strong columns called piers.



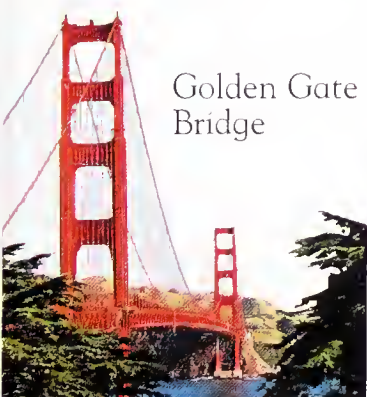
Quebec railroad bridge

Cantilever bridges balance the deck on strong supports.



Tyne Bridge

Arch bridges push their weight into the banks of a river.



Golden Gate Bridge

Suspension bridges hang from cables held up by towers.

Everywhere we go there are obstacles to cross. Bridges and tunnels make it easy to travel over or under rivers, across valleys, and through mountains.

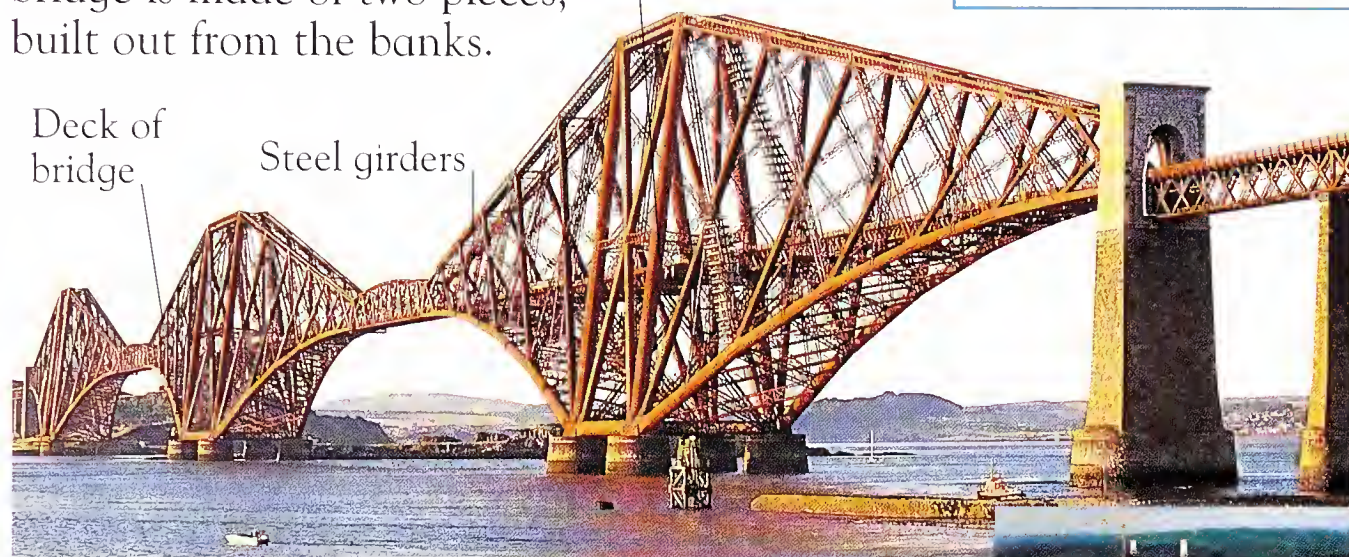
Forth Rail Bridge, Scotland

The deck of this cantilever bridge is made of two pieces, built out from the banks.

Support tower

Deck of bridge

Steel girders



Did you know?
Some bridges in South America are made of braided grass!



Building a suspension bridge



1 Huge cranes build tall columns, called piers, on each side of a river.



2 The towers are built. These are the strongest part of the bridge.



3 Pieces of deck are hung from the strong, steel cables.

Tunnel

Tunnels burrow under barriers such as mountains, seas, and crowded city streets.



Train coming out of a tunnel under the sea

Road tunnel through a mountain



Huge drilling machines bore tunnels through obstacles.

